Nikhil Sharma

Operations Management & Business Analytics
Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University

On the 2026–2027 academic job market

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EDUCATION

2022–present **Ph.D., Operations Management & Business Analytics (expected May 2027)**
Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University.
Dissertation: *Powerful Intermediaries: Practices, Contracts, and Regulation in Supply Chains*
• Ch. 1: Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain (Job Market Paper)
• Ch. 2: Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts
• Ch. 3: The Impact of Curbing Intermediary Practices on Retailers' Performance
Dissertation Committee: John Gray (Chair), James Hill, Jurriaan De Jong, Rakesh Mallipeddi.

2005–2009 **B.E., Electronics and Communications**
Institute of Technology & Management, Gurgaon, India (Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak)

RESEARCH

Methodology & Empirical Toolkit

Primary & Secondary Data Collection, Field Experiments, Lab Experiments, Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference, Synthetic Controls, Matching, Decomposition, LLM/NLP-based methods, Causal Machine Learning

Job Market Paper

2026 *Job Market Paper · Target Submission: October 2026 · M&SOM*
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain
Sharma, N., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.

Under Review

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (Reject and Resubmit) · M&SOM*
Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges: Evidence from a Field Experiment
McKie, E., **Sharma, N.**, Chandrasekaran, A., & Cho, S.

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (3rd Round Major Revision) · Journal of Business Logistics*
Supply Chain Intermediaries' Value Contribution: A Review and Future Opportunities
Sharma, N., Hughes, M., De Jong, J., & Gray, J.

An integrative literature review developing a conceptual framework on how and when supply chain intermediaries create and destroy value.

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (Revision Granted) · Health Affairs Scholar*
Generic Drug Supply Chain Quality and Market Dynamics: A Cross-Sectional Observational Study of Metformin
Gray, J. V., Handfield, R., Divey, S., Sahebi-Fakhrabad, A., Sadeghi, A., **Sharma, N.**, Light, D., Butler, P., Teasdale, B., & Schulman, K. A.

Working Papers

2026 **Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts**
Sharma, N., Hill, J., & Mallipeddi, R.
• Dissertation Chapter 2 · Lab Study 1 complete, Lab Study 2 in planning
• Presented at POMS 2026

Research in Progress

2026 **The Impact of Curbing Intermediary Practices on Retailers' Performance**
Sharma, N., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.
• Dissertation Chapter 3 · Data collection complete

2026 **Multi-contract Retail Decisions under Third-Party Payments**
Sharma, N., Hill, J., & Mallipeddi, R.
• Experiment design complete

Research Awards

2025 **First Place, Edward F. Hayes Advanced Research Forum, The Ohio State University**
Business category, for the dissertation paper "Regulating a Powerful Intermediary: The Effectiveness of Laws to Eliminate Adverse Pharmacy Benefit Manager Practices."

TEACHING

Instructor, Fisher College of Business

2025 **BUSMGT 3230: Introduction to Operations Management**
Instructor of record for 36 students · **SEI: 4.8 / 5.0**

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Fisher College of Business

2022–2025 **BUSMGT 3230: Introduction to Operations Management (x2)**
Including one fully online recitation.

2022–2025 **BUSMGT 7223, BUSMGT 2320, BUSOBA 2321, BUSOBA 4234, BUSOBA 4254, MBA 6273, BUSOBA 7201**
Project Management; Decision Sciences: Statistical Techniques; Business Analytics; Service Operations; Sustainable Projects; Data Analysis Management; Service Operations.

Earlier Teaching

2016–2017 **Mentor, Starbase CT, Hartford, CT**
Public speaking and robotics.

2013 **Ad Hoc Instructor, Accenture Learning & Knowledge Management**

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

Upcoming

2026 **INFORMS Annual Meeting**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain. "Supply Chains, E-Commerce, and Intermediaries" Session, 2:45–4:00 PM, Sunday, November 1 (Moscone South-202, Level 2).

2026 **DSI Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain. Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.

2026 **AI in Business Conference, Fisher College of Business**
Session Chair.

Past

2026 **ISA Annual Meeting**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.

2026 **POMS Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain. Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.

2025 **DSI Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.

2025 **UIUC Supply Chain Management Conference**
Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges.

2025 **POMS Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.

2025 **Indian School of Business (ISB) – POMS Workshop**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2025–present **Emerging-Scholar Ambassadorial Core (ESAC), Journal of Operations Management**
Involved in the creation of "The Doctorate in Operations Management Embassy (D.O.M.E.)"

2025–2027 **Session Chair**
POMS (2027, 2026), INFORMS Annual Meeting (2026), DSI Annual Conference (2025, 2026), AI in Business Conference, Fisher College of Business (2026).

2026 **Panel Co-Moderator**
DSI Panel on AI in Healthcare.

2026 **Ad-Hoc Reviewer**
Decision Sciences Journal.

Professional Memberships

INFORMS, Production and Operations Management Society (POMS), Decision Sciences Institute (DSI), Industry Studies Association (ISA).

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Accenture, India & USA (2009–2022)

12 years across information systems, production operations, and business analytics, with exposure to Financial Services, Life Sciences, Communication/Media/Technology, and Health & Public Services domains.

2014–2022 Associate Manager, Analytics, Travelers (Business Insurance), Hartford, CT

2013–2014 Business Analyst, Biopharmaceutical Research, Covance (LabCorp), Bangalore, India

2012–2013 Product Development, KPN (Communication, Media & Technology), Bangalore, India

2009–2012 Production Operations & Quality Analyst, United Health Group, Bangalore, India

Industry Awards

2019 **Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America)**
Chicago, IL, out of 350+ entries. Pitched in the "Innovate for Society" category:
• Enhancing transparency in CSR donations
• Providing a digital identity for street vendors using blockchain platforms
Collaborators: Prakash Trivedi, Saurabh Gaikwad, Surendra Kushwaha, Ravindra Pratap Singh.

2018 **Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America)**
Chicago, IL, out of 350+ entries. Pitched in the "Innovate for Society" category:
• Transforming the Public Distribution System in developing countries using blockchain to fight corruption
Collaborators: Prakash Trivedi, Saurabh Gaikwad, Ravindra Pratap Singh.

SKILLS & TRAINING

Programming Languages & Software
R, STATA, LaTeX, Python, MS Office

Technology & Platform Training
Ab Initio, Databricks, AWS

Industry Exposure
Healthcare & Insurance, Pharmaceutical Technology, Communications/Media/Technology, General Insurance (P&C)

REFERENCES

John Gray
Dean's Distinguished Professor of Operations; Chair, Operations & Business Analytics, Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University
gray.402@osu.edu · 614-247-8021

Aravind Chandrasekaran
Interim Dean; John W. Berry, Sr. Chair in Business, Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University
chandrasekaran.24@osu.edu · 614-292-4223

James A. Hill
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